Table 3.2 Differences between soft and hard ferromagnetic materials

S.No.	Properties	Soft ferromagnetic materials	Hard ferromagnetic materials
1	When external field is removed	Magnetisation disappears	Magnetisation persists
2	Area of the loop	Small	Large
3	Retentivity	Low	High
4	Coercivity	Low	High
5	Susceptibility and magnetic permeability	High	Low
6	Hysteresis loss	Less	More
7	Uses	Solenoid core, transformer core and electromagnets	Permanent magnets
8	Examples	Soft iron, Mumetal, Stalloy etc.	Carbon steel, Alnico, Lodestone etc.

Applications of hysteresis loop

The significance of hysteresis loop is that it provides information such as retentivity, coercivity, permeability, susceptibility and energy loss during one cycle of magnetisation for each ferromagnetic material. Therefore, the study of hysteresis loop will help us in selecting proper and suitable material for a given purpose. Some examples:

i) Permanent magnets:

The materials with high retentivity, high coercivity and low permeability are suitable for making permanent magnets.
Examples: Carbon steel and Alnico

ii) Electromagnets:

The materials with high initial permeability, low retentivity, low coercivity and thin hysteresis loop with smaller area are preferred to make electromagnets.

Examples: Soft iron and Mumetal (Nickel Iron alloy).

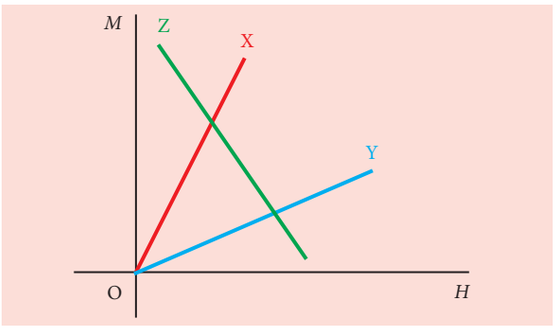
iii) Core of the transformer:

The materials with high initial permeability, large magnetic induction and thin hysteresis loop with smaller area are needed to design transformer cores.

Examples: Soft iron

EXAMPLE 3.11

The following figure shows the variation of intensity of magnetisation with the applied magnetic field intensity for three magnetic materials X, Y and Z. Identify the materials X,Y and Z.



UNIT-3(XII-Physics_Vol-1).indd 150 14-02-2020 20:03:26